

Online Anonymity

with Tor

Online anonymity is quite popular these days for varied reasons. While it gives a voice to the voiceless, it also offers a playing field to mischief makers. This article is a short tutorial on how to go anonymous on the Internet.



To access contents that are otherwise not available due to geographic limitations, netizens are using anonymity. To be anonymous on the Internet means that your IP address is not directly revealed to the host of the content provider, and the request from your browser is routed via proxies. This way the IP address of the proxy system is provided to the content provider, which can be in any geographic location. A number of VPN services have cropped up to help with this. Some are expensive, while some

are cheap. The countries for which they provide the proxy differ, and so do the charges. One way to achieve anonymity is by using Tor connections.

Tor connections do have a bad reputation, but are not necessarily so. Internet users may want to browse the Web anonymously without allowing their government, ISP, or even the website they are browsing to view their IP address or browsing habits.

Now let's see how to create a proxy system to go anonymous on the Internet.

Prerequisites

To create a Tor proxy server of our own, all we need is a UNIX or UNIX-like system. It can be an old PC or laptop, or RaspberryPi zero with the capability of running any lightweight Linux distro and two network connectivity options for the WAN and LAN.

Once you have a running system with any Linux OS installed on it, you can go ahead with the installation of a Tor server. I am using Debian based Linux. The command and process will work only on a similar Linux distro.